

HOMER

THE ODYSSEY

Book 1 / Interior proof

*A new translation in the formal spirit of Longfellow's Divine Comedy,
with an original plate by CastaliaInstitute.*

6.625 x 10.25 inch comic-size hardcover edition / 80# coated paper target

BOOK I

The Man of Many Turnings

Tell me of the man of many turnings,
Muse,
who wandered far, after he had
brought down Troy's
sacred citadel. Many were the people
whose cities
and minds he saw, and many the
griefs he carried
across the sea within his heart,
struggling to save
his life and bring his companions
home. Yet he could
not rescue them, though he desired it
deeply:
their own blind recklessness
destroyed them,
for they consumed the cattle of the
Sun,
and the god took from them the day
of returning.
Begin wherever you will, goddess
born of Zeus;
give us this story also. All the others
now,
who had escaped the steep
destruction of the war,
were home, beyond the battle and
the sea. He alone,
still longing for his wife and for the
day of return,
was held in hollow caves by the lady
nymph,

Calypso, shining among the deathless
ones.

But when the circling years had
brought the hour
the gods had spun for him to reach
his home,
to Ithaca, nor even there escape from
toil
among his friends, the gods took pity
on him all,
save Poseidon; he, unrelenting,
nursed his wrath
against godlike Odysseus, till he
touched
the land he loved.

But Poseidon had gone to the distant
Ethiopians,
to share their hecatomb, at the
earth's far edge;
there the gods were gathered, and he
among them.

The father of gods and men began to
speak,
remembering Aegisthus, whom
famed Orestes killed.

'Look how mortals blame the gods,'
he said, 'and say
their evils come from us. Yet they
themselves, by folly,
make sorrow beyond what fate has
given them.

So Aegisthus, against fate, took
Agamemnon's wife
and murdered him when he came
home from Troy.

He knew the god's warning, for
Hermes had told him:
do not kill the king, do not pursue
his wife;
the son of Atreus will be avenged by
Orestes,
when he comes to manhood and
longs for his country.
But Aegisthus would not listen. Now
he has paid
for all of it at once.
Then the grey-eyed Athena answered
him:
'Father Zeus, son of Cronus, highest
of rulers,
that man deserved the death that
came upon him.
Would that every man who acts as he
did might perish!
But my heart is troubled for the wise
Odysseus,
who has so long been kept from his
friends and home,

Working draft: Odyssey 1.1–50. Greek base text: D. B. Monro and T. W. Allen, *Homeri Opera* (Oxford, 1920), Perseus [tlg0012.tlg002.perseus-grc2](#), pinned in [text/source-lock.md](#). Not approved for final layout.



Athena at the threshold of Odysseus's household. Original concept plate by CastaliaInstitute; informed by Blake's visionary line, not a specific Blake plate. 300 dpi placement candidate; print profile and final approval pending.

PROOF NOTES

This five-page proof tests the shared page architecture for the Odyssey volume: title page, two-column verse pages, full-page plate, and caption treatment. The plate is original work and is not credited to William Blake. Before production approval, lock the typeface licenses and print profile, expand the page map, and complete the six translation review gates.

Preflight status

TEXT: draft / ART: concept-review / LAYOUT: sample proof / RELEASE: not ready